

Evolving Respiratory Illness Situation in Queensland

Key Updates:

- **13 new suspected cases** of acute respiratory illness have been admitted to hospitals in Brisbane on October 14.
- **1 case reported in Townsville** – a patient with a history of travel from Brisbane has been hospitalized at **Townsville University Hospital** with symptoms of acute respiratory distress.
- **A contact tracing unit in Townsville has been activated** to identify and monitor potential contacts, including passengers on the patient's flight.
- **7 cases previously under investigation have tested positive for influenza** and are no longer considered part of the cluster.
- **Total confirmed fatalities linked to the Kelvin Grove nursing home outbreak: 4.**

Public Health Actions:

- **Enhanced surveillance in Queensland hospitals** for severe respiratory cases with unknown causes.
- **Laboratory testing, including genomic sequencing**, is ongoing to determine any shared etiology.
- **Contact tracing teams activated** in Brisbane and Townsville.
- **No new public health restrictions** at this time, but precautions remain in place for high-risk individuals.

What Queenslanders Should Do:

- Remain **vigilant for respiratory symptoms** and seek medical attention if experiencing difficulty breathing, high fever, or persistent cough.
- Individuals with underlying health conditions, older adults, and young children should take **extra precautions**.
- **Travelers from Brisbane to Townsville and other destinations** should monitor symptoms and report any illness to health authorities.
- **Follow standard infection prevention measures**, including hand hygiene and avoiding close contact with symptomatic individuals.

At this time, **there is no confirmed evidence of community-wide transmission of a novel pathogen**, but **investigations remain ongoing**. Queensland Health will continue to provide regular updates as more information becomes available.